

Cover To Cover
Exodus
High Priest & His Garments

This wilderness Tabernacle was in place for 400 years until Solomon's Temple.

On the north the camp was Dan, Asher, Naphtali... their camp total 157,600

On the South of the camp was Gad, Simeon, Reuben... Their Camp totaled 151,450

On the west side of the camp was Benjamin, Manasseh, and Ephraim ... their Camp totaled 108,100

On the east side of the camp was Judah, Issachar, Zebulun... their camp total 186,400

The Levites were the inner ring between the Tabernacle and the tribes.

22,300 Levites.

Merarites

Kohathites

Gershonites

These were clans that descended from Levi's three sons.(Kohath, (furniture) Gershon (curtains, coverings, and hangings), and Merari (Mare - are -ee)(structural frame of the tabernacle...crossbars, posts, and bases, the posts of the surrounding courtyard with their bases, tent pegs, and ropes, including all their equipment and everything related to their use.)

The census only counted men... and this discount was only of men who were capable of fighting in the army. If you were too young, too old, disabled or sickly, you were not counted in This Number....

This means when you add in this group of incapable men to fight in the army, plus the women and children in this list, it totals 3 million people surrounding the Tabernacle.

Each set of the three tribes in their camps were those of the nearest blood relatives.

Example: Manasseh and Ephraim were brothers, they carried the authority of their father, Joseph. They were placed with Benjamin.... Benjamin and Joseph have the same mother, Rachel.

Simeon and Ruben were sons of Jacob's first wife: Leah. Since Levi was set apart as a Priest tribe, he no longer was considered one of the 12 tribes. GAD took his place in the encampment organization.

Why Gad? He was a son of Leah's handmaiden, Zilpah.

Judah, Issachar and Zebulun were Leah's 3 youngest sons.

Dan, Naphtali were born to Rachel's handmaiden, Bilhah.
They were paired with Leah's handmaiden, Zilpah's youngest son, Asher.

The order of the encampment was pointing out or indicating a sort of pecking order of the tribes.

Blood is thicker than water

By grouping them in this way, trouble between the tribes was kept to a minimum.

The Levi's formed something like a moat around a castle.

This represents mediation at work. Mediation between the tribes and God. The people could not come directly to God... They had to go through the the priest, in the way that God laid this out.

All this prefigured one of Christ most important ministries: he was to be our high priest.

Hebrews 4:14

Each of the four tribes had a dominant leader tribe.

Judah on the east

Ephraim on the west

Dan on the NORTH

Reuben on the south

Remember Jacob's blessing... Judah would carry the authority for all of Israel.

So, Judah was the preeminent tribe that ruled over all the other tribes.

Jesus came from the tribe of Judah.

On the west, but nearest to the holy place is Ephraim.

Jacob's split firstborn blessing... Ephriam got one of those halves.

While Judah was given the right to rule over Israel... Ephriam was given the tribes, wealth, and the blessing of fruitfulness. It's called the double portion blessing.

All this is found in Genesis 48,49,50.

Each of the four dominant leaders had a specific symbol or emblem by which they were known... In fact, all the tribes did.

Judah = lion

Jesus is the lion of the tribe of Judah

Ephriam = an Ox

Dan = Eagle

Reuben = Man

These surrounded the Tabernacle, God's dwelling place. They protected the sanctuary of God from the outsiders. And the Lord protected them from their enemies.

Now look at Ezekiel 1: 10.

Ezekiel live 700 years after the time of Moses.

He had visions.

In chapter 1, he has one of heaven and God's throne and it speaks about four living creatures. They had four wings and four faces.

1:10... human faces on front. A lion face on the right. And a bull or ox face on the left and eagle face toward the back.

And wherever the spirit of God went, they went.

In the tabernacle:

The lion was east, the eagle was north, the ox or the bull was west, and the man was on the south.

The four representative symbols of the four dominant tribes.

Now check out Revelation 4:5-8

Early the elections, Saint Jerome, and Irenaeus stated that the gospels cover these for symbols.

Then, in the four gospels...

Matthew = the man. This gospel emphasizes Jesus's humanity... Including a description of his birth and human ancestry.

Mark = the lion... This gospel emphasizes Jesus's kingship

Luke = the ox or bull. Luke emphasizes Jesus's sacrifice. The ox was regularly used in Israel's temple sacrifices. The ox came to symbolize Jesus as our high priest.

John = eagle.... John emphasizes. Jesus is deity... Jesus came from above, like an eagle might come down after soaring in the heavens. John in revelation, saw the future from afar... Like an eagle perched high above the ground.

The symbolism.

Man: symbolize intelligence, rationality. Created in God's image, signifies, dominion and stewardship.

Lion: often associated with royalty and power, the lion represents courage, Strength,, and sovereign authority.

Ox: the symbol of servitude, labor, and sacrifice it represents patience and the relentlessness required in agricultural societies.

Eagle: the symbol of freedom, vision, divine perspective, ability to soar to great heights... It equals transcendence over earthly matters

All of this shows us God's nature: omniscient, omnipotent, enduring, exalted.

They represent the multifaceted administration of Jesus Christ: man: who embodies wisdom... The lion.... Jesus' kingship. The ox... Jesus' servant Hood. And the eagle Jesus' divine nature. God possesses all the qualities needed to manage, direct our individual and collective destinies.

The multifaceted ministry of Jesus Christ... Who embodies wisdom... Man... King ship... Lion... Servant, head... The ox... And divine nature... The eagle. God possesses all the qualities needed to manage, direct our individual and collective destinies.

THE HIGH PRIEST & HOW JESUS FULFILLED EVERY GARMENT

Transcript-Style Teaching Notes (Preachy, Emotive, Clear)

INTRO: A NEW THING GOD INTRODUCED

For six long centuries the children of Jacob — the nation of Israel — had **no priest**, no formal worship system, no sacred garments, no blueprint for how to approach a holy God.

They had lived under the shadow of Egypt.
They had seen Egypt's priests, Egypt's rituals, Egypt's gods.
Egypt became their *lens*... and God had to *break the lens*.

So when God brings them to Sinai, He gets **precise, specific, uncompromising**.

Why?
Because He wasn't just designing garments...
He was designing **a picture of His Son**.

Every thread... every color... every bell... every stone... every stitch...
was a prophecy wrapped in linen.

1. THE PRIEST — DRESSED FROM THE INSIDE OUT

A. THE UNDERGARMENTS – WHITE LINEN (MODESTY & PURITY)

White linen britches and a long tunic — simple, pure, modest.
Not sensual like the pagan temples. They would minister naked. Or in sensual clothes. Not inappropriate like the false priests of Egypt.

God was saying: “*My priests do not approach Me on their terms. They come in purity.*”

Fulfillment in Jesus — The Perfect Righteousness

Fine linen = righteousness.
Jesus didn't *put on* righteousness — He *is* righteousness.

- **2 Cor. 5:21** – He *knew no sin*.
- **1 Pet. 2:22** – He *committed no sin*.
- **Heb. 7:26** – He is *holy, blameless, pure*.

When the priest dressed in white... it was preaching Jesus.

2. THE BLUE ROBE – SEAMLESS, HEAVENLY, RINGING WITH LIFE

A seamless robe, all blue — the color of heaven.

Around the hem? Alternating **gold bells** and **pomegranates** — sound and fruitfulness.

Why bells?

Because if the people heard the bells, they knew:

“Our priest is alive... our priest is ministering... our priest is standing before God for us.”

Fulfillment in Jesus — The Living, Heavenly High Priest

He came from heaven (John 6:38).

He is the Heavenly High Priest (Heb. 3:1).

Appointed by God Himself (Heb. 5:5–6).

The bells ring in the resurrection:

- **Heb. 7:25** – “He ever lives to make intercession.”
- **Rev. 1:18** – “I am alive forevermore.”

The pomegranates?

Symbols of fruitfulness — blue (heaven), purple (royalty), scarlet (sacrifice).

All fulfilled in Christ:

Heaven-sent.

King of Kings.

Sacrificial Lamb.

3. THE EPHOD — CARRYING GOD’S PEOPLE WITH STRENGTH

The ephod was multicolored: gold thread, blue, purple, scarlet, linen.

On each shoulder?

An onyx stone.

Six tribal names on one side. Six on the other.

The priest literally **carried the people on his shoulders** before the Lord.

Fulfillment in Jesus — The Shepherd Who Lifts His Children

- **Luke 15:4–5** – He carries the lost sheep on His shoulders.
- **Isaiah 9:6** – The government rests on His shoulders.
- **Isaiah 46:4** – “I will carry you.”
- **Heb. 2:10** – He brings many sons to glory.

What the high priest carried temporarily... Jesus carries eternally.

4. THE BREASTPLATE — 12 STONES OVER HIS HEART

Twelve gemstones, each engraved with a tribe's name.

The priest carried them on his heart whenever he entered the Holy Place.

Stones on the shoulders = strength.

Stones over the heart = love.

And the same stones appear again in Revelation — the foundations of New Jerusalem.

Your name is precious stone to God.

Zebulum stone was Emerald green.

Issachar stone was topaz yellow

Judah stone was Ruby dark red

Gad Stone was diamond White

Simeon stone was sapphire blue

Reuben stone was turquoise, blue green

Benjamin Stone was amethyst purple

Manesseh stone was agate gray striped

Ephraim stone was Jacinth orange

Naphtali stone was Jasper dark green

Asher's Stone was Onyx Black

Dan Stone was BERYL... Green

Fulfillment in Jesus — Love Engraved Forever

- **John 10:11** – He lays down His life for the sheep.
- **John 15:13** – No greater love.
- **Heb. 4:15** – A High Priest who *feels* what we feel.
- **Luke 10:20** – Your names are written in heaven.
- **Rev. 21:12–14** – The tribes remembered forever.

Your name has weight to Jesus. Eternal weight.

5. THE URIM & THUMMIM — GOD’S GUIDANCE

In the breastplate pocket were the mysterious Urim (lights) and Thummim (perfections). Likely two stones — one yes, one no — a divine means of guidance.

The high priest sought the will of God with them.

Fulfillment in Jesus — God’s Will Revealed

Jesus doesn’t pull out stones.

He *is* the revelation of God’s will.

- “If you’ve seen Me, you’ve seen the Father.”
- “I am the light of the world.”
- “I am the truth.”

Jesus is God’s final “YES” and God’s final “AMEN.”

6. THE TURBAN & GOLD PLATE — “HOLINESS TO THE LORD”

A turban with a golden plate across the forehead:
“HOLINESS TO THE LORD.”

The priest had to bear guilt symbolically and stand acceptable before God.

Fulfillment in Jesus — The Holy One Who Makes Us Holy

- **Luke 1:35** – The Holy One.
- **Acts 3:14** – The Holy and Righteous One.
- **Heb. 7:26** – Holy, blameless, exalted.

He bears our guilt:

- **Isaiah 53:6** – Our iniquity laid on Him.
- **1 Pet. 2:24** – He bore our sins.

He makes *us* acceptable:

- **Eph. 1:6** – Accepted in the Beloved.

7. THE SASH — SERVANTHOOD WRAPPED AROUND PRIESTHOOD

The sash was woven with blue, purple, and scarlet.
It wrapped around the ephod like an emblem of dedication and service.

Fulfillment in Jesus — The Servant King

- **Matt. 20:28** – He came to serve.
- **Phil. 2:5–8** – He took on the form of a servant.
- **John 13** – He girded Himself to wash their feet.

When Jesus wrapped that towel around His waist...
He was wearing His priestly sash.

8. THE DAY OF ATONEMENT — THE GRAND MOMENT

Once a year.
One man.
One day.
One offering.

The High Priest entered the Holy of Holies trembling...
Because if he failed...
The nation remained unforgiven.

Fulfillment in Jesus — The Final Atonement

- **Heb. 9:11–12** – He entered with His own blood.
- **Heb. 10:10** – Once for all.
- **Heb. 9:24** – He appears in God’s presence for us.
- **Heb. 4:14–16** – We approach boldly.

Jesus is both the Priest *and* the Sacrifice:

- **John 1:29** – The Lamb of God.
- **1 John 2:2** – The atonement.
- **Heb. 7:27** – He offered Himself.

CONCLUSION: JESUS — THE FINAL, PERFECT HIGH PRIEST

Every garment...

Every color...

Every stone...

Every sound of every bell...

Every drop of blood on the Day of Atonement...

was preaching one message:

“Jesus is coming.”

And when He came...

He fulfilled it all.

He is the High Priest dressed in holiness,
carrying your name,
covering your sins,
interceding for you,
and making you welcome before the throne.

What the old covenant hinted at...

Jesus completed with His life, His love, and His blood.